3.3.1 Hypertension



A normal blood pressure reads as 120/80 where 120 denotes the systolic pressure and 80 denotes the diastolic pressure. When the value of blood pressure is 140/90 and above, then it is called as high blood pressure or hypertension.

Blood pressure is the force of blood pressing against the walls of the blood vessels (arteries) that deliver oxygen-rich blood from the heart to all parts of the body.

Causes

- Smoking
- High blood cholesterol
- Over weight
- High salt intake
- Alcohol intake
- Renal disorder
- Endocrine disorder
- Vascular disorder
- Neurological disorder
- Problems with pregnancy
- Acute stress

Risk factors

- **Non modifiable**

Family history

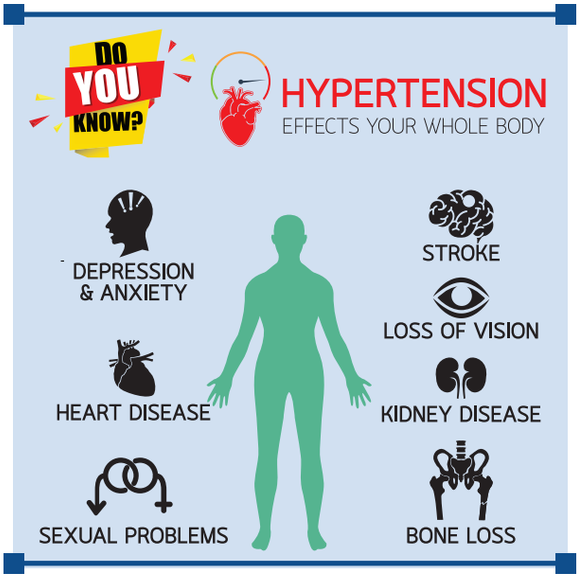
Gender, age

- **Modifiable**

Stress

Obesity

Substance abuse



Signs & Symptoms

- Fatigue
- Head ache
- Shortness of Breath
- Giddiness
- Palpitation
- Ringing in the ears
- Epistaxis
- Heart failure
- Cardiac pain

XII_Nursing_Vocational_Unit 3.indd 61 1/11/2020 2:36:20 PM